

VERANKE

FIRST APPEARANCE New Avengers #1 (January 2005) as Spider-Woman; New Avengers #40 (June 2008) as Veranke.

REAL NAME Veranke **OCCUPATION** Ruler

BASE Skrull empire **HEIGHT/WEIGHT/EYES/HAIR** Variable

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Shapeshifting, plus Spider-Woman's powers. Ruler of the Skrull empire.



As a SKRULL princess from Teyranx 7, Veranke challenged King Dorrek for ignoring Skrull prophecies, and she was banished for her trouble. After GALACTUS devoured the Skrull homeworld and the Annihilation Wave (see pp. 30–1) destroyed most of the

empire, Veranke was seen as a visionary and elevated to queen. She declared that Earth was to be the new Skrull homeworld and so launched the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326–7). As part of this, she replaced SPIDER-WOMAN just before the reformation of the AVENGERS. At the climax of the Secret Invasion, she was killed by Norman Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN). **MF**

VERDUGO

FIRST APPEARANCE Incredible Hulk vol. 3, #36 (March 2002)

REAL NAME Sandra Verdugo

OCCUPATION Mercenary, Home Base operative **BASE** Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 8 in **WEIGHT** 122 lbs **EYES** Black **HAIR** Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Recipient of H-Section

Programming; is able to recover from most injuries and revive from death; brilliant marksman, athlete and hand-to-hand combatant.

A one-time member of the US Special Forces, Sandra Verdugo worked as a mercenary before becoming pregnant by Doc SAMSON. When Sandra's eight-year-old son was kidnapped, the clandestine organisation Home Base offered her a deal. Home Base would retrieve her son if Sandra would agree to become one of their operatives. Her mission would be to capture the HULK. Sandra agreed but it wasn't long before she turned on her new employers. With the help of Doc Samson and the Hulk, Sandra was reunited with her son just before Home Base's headquarters were destroyed. Mother and child are thought to have perished in the conflagration. **AD**



VERMIN

FIRST APPEARANCE Captain America #272 (August 1982)

REAL NAME Edward Whelan

OCCUPATION Unknown **BASE** Mobile

HEIGHT 6 ft **WEIGHT** 220 lbs **EYES** Red **HAIR** Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superhuman strength and speed.

Teeth and nails can cut through soft metals. Greatly enhanced sense of smell. Can command rats to attack an enemy.

Villains BARON ZEMO and Arnim ZOLA found Whelan living on the streets of Manhattan and genetically modified him into a rat-man. They sent him to kill CAPTAIN AMERICA, but he failed. He was unstable, and often turned on his masters. During the Civil War (see pp. 84–5), he helped out both the THUNDERBOLTS and the HOOD. Recently, he battled the new KRAVEN THE HUNTER and even tangled with his old foe SPIDER-MAN, who was wearing a DAREDEVIL costume at the time.

MT, MF



VERNARD, KRISTOFF

FIRST APPEARANCE Fantastic Four Vol. 1 #247 (October 1982)

REAL NAME Kristoff Vernard

OCCUPATION Kristoff Vernard **BASE** Latveria

HEIGHT 4 ft 11 in, (in suit) 6 ft 7 in **WEIGHT** 103 lbs, (in suit) 293 lbs

EYES Brown **HAIR** Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Enhanced strength; damage resistance; ability to generate force fields or fire concussion beams.

Kristoff Vernard is believed by some to be the biological son of Nathaniel Richards, making him the half-brother of Reed Richards (MISTER FANTASTIC). After the death of Kristoff's mother in Latveria, DOCTOR DOOM discovered the boy and groomed him as his heir. When Doom appeared to have died, his Doombots brainwashed Kristoff into believing that he was Doom. Kristoff donned an armored suit and attacked the FANTASTIC FOUR, though his enemies eventually helped restore his true identity. Kristoff later teamed up with Nathaniel Richards to reclaim Latveria from usurpers. **DW**



VIBRAXAS

FIRST APPEARANCE Fantastic Four Vol. 1 #390 (July 1994)

REAL NAME N'Kano

OCCUPATION Adventurer **BASE** Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 10 in **WEIGHT** 165 lbs

EYES Brown **HAIR** Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Can generate intense vibratory force.

The young Wakandan N'Kano gained his powers when an experimental Vibrasurge project backfired, seemingly killing his mother. Taken in by the BLACK PANTHER, he traveled to America and became a member of the Fantastic Force under the name Vibraxas. When he accidentally murdered a gang member, Vibraxas went back to Wakanda to stand trial, but he was exonerated. After the Fantastic Force disbanded, Vibraxas found love with Queen Divine Justice, a member of the "Dora Milaje" who serve the Wakandan king as bodyguards and wives-in-training. **DW**



VINDICATOR

FIRST APPEARANCE Uncanny X-Men #139 (November 1980)

REAL NAME Heather McNeil Hudson

OCCUPATION Member of Alpha Flight

BASE Tamarind Island, British Columbia, Canada

HEIGHT 5 ft 5 in **WEIGHT** 120 lbs **EYES** Green **HAIR** Red

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Thermal-energy battlesuit provides ability to fly, generate force fields and fire concussive blasts.

Heather McNeil Hudson and her husband James Hudson helped found the Canadian Super Hero group ALPHA FLIGHT. James took leadership of Alpha Flight as the costumed hero GUARDIAN, and Heather did the same after his apparent death. As the new leader of Alpha Flight, Heather called herself Vindicator and wore a modified version of her husband's battlesuit. She and James later had a baby girl and left on a mission to deep space. After M-Day, the Collective—a man burning with the powers removed from most of the world's mutants—clashed with Alpha Flight and killed most of its members, including Heather. **DW, MF**

